

DJ GLADNEY (#25), NEW YORK YANKEES

Level: AA (Somerset Patriots)

Position(s): OF

Age: 24

B/T: R/R

Dates Seen: 6/10/26, 6/12/26, 6/14/26

Projected Role: Upper Minors Depth

Ceiling: MLB Fourth Outfielder

Floor: Organizational Depth

Season	2026
Team	NY Yankees
Level	MILB
G	58
PA	249
HR	13
AVG	.272
OBP	.331
SLG	.513
wOBA	.363
wRC+	121

Swing

Video from the 2024 season shows Gladney with a slightly closed, athletic stance with his hands relaxed by his head. As the pitch approached, Gladney would provide a low leg lift with a minimal load as he strode. His stride was not always consistent; sometimes he was direct at the pitcher, other times he opened up more. As he swung, Gladney would drop his hands and bat path. His hands looked like a major concern, as the dip in his swing started with his hands and caused a longer swing that would make him susceptible to weak contact, velocity up in the zone, and missing hittable pitches. His bat path was flatter as well, making it more likely that when he did make contact, it would be off the barrel or he would be more under the ball. This year with Somerset, Gladney has opened his stance slightly while standing more upright, allowing himself to stride more consistently to finish closed to the pitcher. There are still inconsistencies in his front-foot landing spot, but his stride direction is generally consistent now. Gladney keeps his low leg lift, but has made noticeable differences to his hands during his swing. Gladney has cleaned up the first movement of his hands and now throws the bat and the knob more directly at the ball, eliminating the dip that had previously elongated his swing. By being more direct, Gladney has compacted his swing and is shorter to the ball, increasing bat control and power. His bat path is still relatively flat and lacks the slight uppercut common in today's game, but the rhythm and timing of his hands and stride have allowed him to add more coil off his back leg, improving his power and contact. On 6/12, Gladney really displayed his newfound power, blasting a 474-foot 3-run blast to left center to give the Patriots the lead in the first.

Approach

The most glaring issue is Gladney's strikeout and walk rates. Gladney has always been a high-K%, low-BB% hitter, displaying an aggressive approach. In 2025 (100 games), Gladney struck out 126 times while walking 21 times, for a 31.1% K rate and a 5.2% walk rate. This year,

Gladney has been unable to lower his K rate, which currently stands at 32.5%. His BB% rate has improved to 8.0%, but it's not enough to offset his high K rate. Gladney needs to improve his plate discipline and chase rate, as he is producing great results when he makes contact.

Projection

Gladney began his professional career with the White Sox, where in 2025, he hit 10 home runs in 100 games with a .645 OPS. In December of 2025, Gladney signed with the Yankees, and since joining their organization, he has immediately outperformed expectations. Notably, he has already reached 12 home runs through 50 games with the Yankees, after making considerable changes to his batting stance and swing mechanics that have contributed to his success in 2026. During the first half of the 2026 Eastern League season, Gladney has posted a slash line of .272/.331/.513, ranking in the top 15 in several major categories: 10th in home runs, 3rd in RBIs, 15th in batting average, and 11th in slugging percentage. Gladney's athletic ability and good arm also allow him to move between CF and RF, and his bat is productive enough to also split time at DH. At 24, Gladney has an athletic build and could be considered a late bloomer with room to grow and provide value as a bat-first outfielder for the Yankees in the future if his production and improvement in the first half of 2026 continue.

Development Path

The rhythm of the leg lift, with his hands more direct at the plate, has led to a career turnaround in 2026. Gladney has tightened up some inconsistencies in his swing and shown improvement. Gladney's next path to improvement should be improving his plate discipline to combat his gaudy K% and low BB%. Gladney's BB/K ratio is .25. This is an improvement from his year prior with the White Sox, but still does not indicate good plate discipline. Gladney stood out as a 24-year-old who dominated the Eastern League early in the year, making significant swing adjustments to produce these results. The Yankees should watch to see if he can cut down on whiffs and make better swing decisions while considering him for promotion.